

Introduction Class: Intro to TOEIC & Travel Anecdotes

DDRS

1. Environmental Responsibility (Environnement : Mobilité et Empreinte Carbone): Environmental Impact of Global Mobility & Sustainable Travel Choices.

2. Social & Societal Responsibility (Responsabilité Sociétale : Tourisme Responsable & Inclusion) DD&RS Focus: Cultural Awareness, Inclusive Travel, and Respect for Host Communities.

3. Economic Viability & Professional Ethics (Économie & Éthique Professionnelle) DD&RS Focus: Professional Ethics in Global Business and Sustainable Corporate Travel Management.

Lesson Plan

1. Introductions
2. TOEIC: Explanations, preparation and strategy
3. Travel anecdotes
4. Grammar point
5. Debrief

Objectives

By the end of this session, students will be able to:

1. **Understand the TOEIC Exam:**
 - Understand the structure, scoring system, and strategic pacing of the TOEIC Listening & Reading test, shifting from general language study to targeted exam technique.
2. **Master High-Frequency Travel & Professional Collocations:**
 - Identify and correctly utilize essential B2/C1-level travel collocations and idioms in professional and conversational contexts.
3. **Produce Advanced Narrative Structures:**
 - Review and accurately apply narrative tenses (Past Simple vs. Past Continuous) and inversion structures (e.g., *Hardly had I...*) to enhance complexity in speaking and writing.

4. **Integrate DD&RS Principles into Professional Travel:**

- Connect global travel scenarios to concepts of sustainable mobility, cultural respect, and responsible tourism.

5. **Prepare for the Class 5 Formative Evaluation (FE):**

- Understand the exact assessment criteria—**vocabulary, fluency, grammar, and TOEIC-readiness**—for the upcoming 30-minute graded speaking activity that determines their "**Go / No-Go**" status.

Getting Started: Icebreaker Activity

Activity: The Professional Two Truths & One Goal

Take 1 minute to write down three statements about yourself.

- **Two Truths:** Share facts related to your work, studies, or daily habits (e.g., *"I manage social media campaigns for a tech startup,"* or *"I have never drunk a cup of coffee in my life"*).
- **One Goal:** State a specific objective regarding your English proficiency or career future (e.g., *"I need a TOEIC score of 800 to transfer to our company's international office"*).

How to play: Working with a partner or in your small group, share your three statements. Your peers will try to guess which statement is your professional goal and which two are facts about your life.

TOEIC Diagnostic & Strategy (30 mins): Brief introduction to the structure of the TOEIC exam.

The TOEIC Test Structure

The TOEIC Listening and Reading test is a paper-and-pencil multiple-choice assessment that takes approximately **2 hours and 30 minutes** in total (including administrative time). It is divided into two main sections:

- **Section I: Listening (approx. 45 minutes / 100 questions)**
 - **Part 1:** Photographs (6 questions) – Choose the statement that best describes a picture.
 - **Part 2:** Question-Response (25 questions) – Listen to a question and three potential responses.
 - **Part 3:** Conversations (39 questions) – Listen to short dialogues and answer comprehension questions.
 - **Part 4:** Talks (30 questions) – Listen to short monologues (announcements, talks) and answer questions.
- **Section II: Reading (75 minutes / 100 questions)**
 - **Part 5:** Incomplete Sentences (30 questions) – Fill in the blanks with grammar or vocabulary.
 - **Part 6:** Text Completion (16 questions) – Fill in missing words/phrases within longer reading passages.
 - **Part 7:** Reading Comprehension (54 questions) – Read single or multiple-passage texts (emails, articles, ads) and answer questions.

How the TOEIC is Graded

Unlike academic tests where you might aim for a percentage out of 100, the TOEIC uses a **scaled scoring system**:

- **Score Range:** Each section (Listening and Reading) is scored on a scale from **5 to 495 points**.
- **Total Score:** Combined, the total score ranges from **10 to 990 points**. There is no penalty for guessing wrong, so you should always answer every question.
- **CEFR Alignment:** Scores are often mapped to the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR), typically ranging from A1 (Beginner) to C1/C2 (Advanced/Professional proficiency).

Examples of TOEIC questions

Listening Part 3 (Short Conversation)

- **Audio Context:** Two colleagues talking in an office.
 - *Man:* "Excuse me, Sarah. Do you know if the catering order for tomorrow's client lunch has been finalized yet? The supplier called to confirm headcount."
 - *Woman:* "I was supposed to do that this morning, but I got pulled into an urgent budget meeting with the director. Let me check my notes... Ah, I have the draft right here, but I haven't hit send."
 - *Man:* "No worries. Just make sure you update the dietary restrictions for Mr. Vance before you submit it."
- **Question:** What does the woman imply she needs to do?
- **Options:**
 - (A) Cancel a client lunch
 - (B) Review a budget report with the director
 - (C) Finalize and send a catering order
 - (D) Update a meeting schedule
- **Answer: (C)**
- *B2 Insight:* This tests your ability to infer intent and track multi-step workplace tasks rather than just listening for isolated keywords.

Reading Part 5 (Incomplete Sentences - Vocabulary/Grammar)

- **Prompt:** "To ensure that all departments meet the end-of-year targets, management has decided to _____ the approval process for new software purchases."
- **Options:**
 - (A) accelerate
 - (B) accelerate's (*or alternative distractor like acceleration*)
 - (C) accelerated
 - (D) accelerating
- **Answer: (A) accelerate**

- *B2 Insight:* TOEIC Part 5 frequently tests your knowledge of grammatical structure after infinitive markers (*to + verb*), combined with professional business vocabulary (like streamlining or speeding up a corporate process).

Reading Part 7 (Reading Comprehension - Text Message Chain / Multi-passage style)

- **Context (Text Message Chain):**
 - 10:15 AM - Mark Chen: "Hi team, are we still on track to pitch the marketing strategy to Apex Corp this Thursday? I'm putting the final slides together now."
 - 10:18 AM - Elena Rostova: "The slides look great, Mark, but I just heard from facilities. The main conference room is undergoing unexpected plumbing repairs, so we won't be able to use the projector there."
 - 10:20 AM - David Kim: "Don't panic. I already booked Room 3B as a backup. It has a smart screen, so Mark's presentation format will work fine."
- **Question:** What is David Kim suggesting?
- **Options:**
 - (A) Rescheduling the pitch meeting for next week
 - (B) Using an alternative location for the presentation
 - (C) Fixing the plumbing issue in the main conference room
 - (D) Updating the slides to fit a different screen format
- **Answer: (B)**
- *B2 Insight:* Part 7 often uses modern workplace communication formats (like chat logs or email chains) and requires you to track problem-solving across multiple speakers.

Examples of common pitfalls:

- **Falling for "Sound-Alikes" in Listening:** In Parts 1–4, test-makers often use words in the incorrect answer choices that sound very similar to words heard in the audio (e.g., hearing *report* and choosing an option containing *airport* or *support*).
- **Overspending Time on Part 5:** Spending too much time agonizing over a single grammar or vocabulary question in Part 5, which leaves you rushed and unable to finish the lengthy Reading Comprehension texts in Part 7.
- **Ignoring Context and Literal Translation:** Translating sentences word-for-word instead of looking at contextual clues (especially in Part 5 vocabulary and Part 7 inference questions), leading to unnatural word choices or misunderstood idioms.

Preparation Strategies

Active Vocabulary Log: Keep a notebook specifically for business terms, phrasal verbs, and common workplace collocations (e.g., *launch a product*, *meet a deadline*) encountered during practice tests.

Simulated Full-Length Practice Tests: Take at least 2 or 3 full-length, timed practice tests under actual exam conditions to build the mental stamina required for the full 2.5-hour duration.

Targeted Error Analysis: Do not just score your practice tests; maintain an error log detailing *why* you got a question wrong (e.g., misheard audio, grammar rule gap, or time pressure) so you can fix specific weaknesses.

Time management strategies

- **The "Pacing Checkpoint" for Reading:** Aim to finish Parts 5 and 6 (46 questions total) within **20 to 22 minutes**, leaving yourself a solid 50 to 53 minutes to tackle the 54 questions in Part 7.
- **The "Never Leave Blanks" Rule:** Because there is **no penalty for guessing** on the TOEIC, never leave an answer blank. If you are running out of time, quickly bubble in a guess for remaining questions before the proctor calls time.
- **Move On Immediately (The 10-Second Rule):** If you are unsure of a Listening question (Parts 2, 3, or 4), guess instantly and force your eyes/mind to look at the next set of questions. Linger over a missed question causes you to miss the *next* audio prompt.

6. **Warm-up & Vocabulary Builder: Travel Idioms & Collocations (20 mins):** Introduce travel and mobility vocabulary (e.g., *off the beaten track*, *itinerary*, *layover*, *commute*).

Examples of travel collocations:

Travel Collocations

1. Book a flight / hotel (Verb + Noun)

- **Meaning:** To reserve travel accommodation or transportation.
- **Example:** "Make sure you **book your flight** well in advance to secure a reasonable price."

2. Board a plane / train (Verb + Noun)

- **Meaning:** To get onto an aircraft or railway carriage to begin travel.
- **Example:** "Passengers are kindly requested to **board the plane** through Gate 24."

3. Check in for a flight (Verb Phrase + Preposition)

- **Meaning:** To register your arrival at a hotel or confirm your presence and get a boarding pass at an airport.
- **Example:** "You can **check in for your flight** online 24 hours before departure."

4. Clear customs / security (Verb + Noun)

- **Meaning:** To pass through official checkpoints at a border or airport.
- **Example:** "It took us nearly an hour to **clear customs** after landing at the international terminal."

5. Miss a flight / connection (Verb + Noun)

- **Meaning:** To arrive too late to board a scheduled vehicle.
- **Example:** "Heavy traffic on the ring road meant we nearly **missed our flight**."

6. Extend a stay (Verb + Noun)

- **Meaning:** To prolong the duration of a hotel booking or trip.
- **Example:** "The conference was so productive that I decided to **extend my stay** by an extra two days."

7. A window / aisle seat (Adjective + Noun)

- **Meaning:** Specific types of passenger seats on a plane, train, or bus.

- **Example:** *"I always request **an aisle seat** on long-haul flights so I can stretch my legs easily."*

8. A round-trip ticket (Adjective + Noun)

- **Meaning:** A pass or fare for a journey to a place and back again.
- **Example:** *"It is usually much cheaper to buy **a round-trip ticket** than two separate one-way fares."*

9. Hand luggage / Carry-on baggage (Adjective + Noun)

- **Meaning:** Small bags that passengers are allowed to keep with them in the cabin.
- **Example:** *"Please ensure all liquids in your **hand luggage** comply with airport security regulations."*

10. Peak travel season (Adjective + Noun)

- **Meaning:** The time of year when a high volume of people travel for holidays.
- **Example:** *"Prices for accommodation double if you visit the coast during **peak travel season**."*

10 Common Travel Idioms

1. To hit the road

- **Meaning:** To set off on a journey or leave.
- **Example:** *"We've packed all our bags, so let's **hit the road** before the traffic gets heavy."*

2. To hit the nail on the head (Wait, let's stick strictly to travel!) -> To take the scenic route

- **Meaning:** To take a longer, more picturesque way to get somewhere instead of the fastest route.
- **Example:** *"We had plenty of time before check-in, so we decided to **take the scenic route** along the coast."*

3. To catch the bug (for something)

- **Meaning:** To suddenly develop a strong enthusiasm or passion for something (very often used for travel: *to catch the travel bug*).
- **Example:** *"After visiting Japan last year, she completely **caught the travel bug** and is already planning her next three trips."*

4. To be in the driver's seat

- **Meaning:** To be in control of a situation, project, or journey.
- **Example:** *"Now that we've finalized the budget and itinerary, I really feel like I'm **in the driver's seat** for this trip."*

5. To jump on the bandwagon

- **Meaning:** To join a popular trend or activity because everyone else is doing it (often applied to trendy holiday destinations).

DDRS Vocabulary

Développement Durable et Responsabilité Sociétale (*Sustainable Development and Social Responsibility*)

1. Environmental Sustainability (Environnement)

- **Carbon Footprint Tracking / Reduction:** Measuring and mitigating greenhouse gas emissions from flights, ground transport, and hotel stays.
- **Eco-Certification / Ecolabels:** Official certifications for sustainable tourism providers (e.g., *Green Globe, EU Ecolabel, EarthCheck*).
- **Circular Economy in Hospitality:** Reducing single-use plastics, implementing food-waste management, and recycling water systems in resorts and hotels.
- **Biodiversity Conservation:** Tourism management strategies that protect local ecosystems and wildlife habitats from overtourism.

2. Social & Societal Responsibility (Responsabilité Sociétale)

- **Community-Based Tourism (CBT):** Ensuring local communities directly benefit economically and socially from tourism activities rather than external corporations.
- **Cultural Heritage Preservation:** Safeguarding local traditions, historical sites, and indigenous cultures from commercial exploitation or degradation.
- **Accessible / Inclusive Tourism:** Designing travel infrastructure, transport, and attractions that accommodate travelers with disabilities or special needs.
- **Fair Labor Practices:** Ensuring fair wages, safe working conditions, and ethical treatment for hotel, restaurant, and tour-operating staff.

3. Governance & Economic Viability (Gouvernance & Économie)

- **Sustainable Destination Management:** Long-term planning by local authorities to balance tourist influx with resident quality of life (combating overtourism).

- **Ethical Supply Chain Management:** Sourcing local food, materials, and services to support the regional economy and lower transportation emissions (short-circuit distribution).
- **Transparency and Reporting:** Corporate social responsibility (CSR) reporting where travel agencies and airlines disclose their ecological and social impact metrics.

7. **Structured Discussion: Travel Anecdotes (30 mins):** In pairs or small groups of 3, students share a memorable travel experience or disruption using newly learned vocabulary and narrative past tenses.

8. **Grammar Focus: Narrative Tenses & Complex Structures (25 mins):** Review and practice past simple vs. past continuous and inversion structures (e.g., *Hardly had I arrived when...*) crucial for advanced language production.

Additional Material / Homework

Grammar Practice: Narrative Tenses & Inversions

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using the correct form of the verbs in brackets (Past Simple or Past Continuous) or supply the appropriate inversion word where indicated.

1. While Elena _____ (print) the boarding passes, her colleague _____ (realize) that the passport had been left on the office desk.
2. **Hardly** _____ the clients _____ (step) into the conference room when the projector suddenly stopped working.
3. As the executive _____ (read) through the merger agreement, the legal team _____ (arrive) with the final revisions.
4. **No sooner** _____ we _____ (clear) customs than our connecting flight was unexpectedly cancelled.
5. While the pilot _____ (announce) the turbulence, the flight attendants quickly _____ (secure) the beverage carts.
6. **Not only** _____ the train _____ (run) three hours late, but it also missed the scheduled stop at the airport terminal.

Exercise 2: Sentence Transformation

*Rewrite the following sentences starting with the bolded words to create an **inversion structure**, keeping the same meaning.*

7. I had barely locked the front door when I remembered I forgot my passport.
 - Rewrite starting with: **Hardly...**
8. We rarely experience such severe delays during the peak travel season.
 - Rewrite starting with: **Rarely...**
9. She not only missed her morning meeting, but she also lost her luggage.
 - Rewrite starting with: **Not only...**
 -

Answer Key

1. **was printing / realized** (Past continuous for the background action interrupted/coinciding with a single past action).
2. **had... stepped** (Standard structure for *Hardly had + subject + past participle*).
3. **was reading / arrived** (Past continuous for an ongoing action in the past when another action happened).
4. **had... cleared** (*No sooner had + subject + past participle*).
5. **was announcing / secured** (or *were securing* - background continuous action interrupted or running alongside another).
6. **did... run** (Inversion with a past simple verb using *did* because of "Not only" at the beginning).
7. **Hardly had I locked the front door when I remembered I forgot my passport.**
8. **Rarely do we experience such severe delays during the peak travel season.**
9. **Not only did she miss her morning meeting, but she also lost her luggage.**

Class Debrief & Personal Takeaways

Take 3 minutes to complete this section before you leave.

1. Key Learnings & Review

- In one sentence, what was the most important thing you learned today?

2. Future Application (Connecting to your FE / Career)

- How will you apply today's vocabulary, grammar, or travel/tourism concepts to your (FE)?

3. Action Plan & Next Steps

- What specific homework or preparation do you need to complete before our next session?

4. Questions & Clarifications

- Do you have any lingering questions for your teacher about today's material?
